



MYHISTAMATE GUIDE

The restaurant guide.

Eat out with confidence — without filling your histamine bucket.

FROM ME, TO YOU

For a long time I turned down restaurant invitations. Then I learned a few simple rules — and I could go out again, without fear. I'm leaving all of them here for you.

With love, Cătălina

Founder, MyHistamate

1

PREPARATION

Before you leave home

- **Choose the place in advance**

Not on an empty stomach, in a rush, at the door.

- **Read the menu online**

See ahead of time what you can order in peace.

- **Call and ask**

Good places are happy to answer questions.

- **Have a safe snack first**

On a big appetite, the temptation to slip is bigger.

IF YOU'RE PLANNING A FREER MEAL

Some people take a DAO enzyme supplement before a meal they know will be heavier — talk to your doctor first.

2

THE CHOICE

Which places are friendlier

SAFER

- Grill / rotisserie
- Simply cooked food
- Very fresh fish
- Home-style cooking
- Short menu
- Cooked to order
- Accepts changes
- Breakfast / brunch

RISKIER

- Sushi & canned food
- Cheeses & wines
- Cured meats / smoked
- Old street food
- Fermented (kimchi, pickles)
- Buffet / all-you-can-eat
- Tapas / cold platters
- Sauces you don't know

THE SIMPLE RULE

The fresher and simpler the food is cooked, the safer it is for you.

3

THE MENU

Look for words, not dishes

You don't need to know every dish. Watch how it's cooked:

GREEN WORDS

- Fresh
- Grilled
- Boiled
- Steamed
- Simple
- Baked
- Made to order
- Cooked on the spot

RED WORDS

- Aged
- Smoked
- Fermented
- Marinated
- Preserved
- In sauce
- Spicy
- Reduction / glazed

THE SIMPLE RULE

Don't focus on the name of the dish. Focus on how it was prepared.

USEFUL PHRASES

Ask without fear. It's your health.

Your questions aren't a bother. A good place wants you to feel well — and you're far from the only one who asks.

ASK YOURSELF QUICKLY

Is it fresh? Is it simple? Is it on the green list?

- **“Can it be cooked fresh, with no sauce and no cheese?”**
- **“Do you have something grilled and simple, with rice or potatoes?”**
- **“Is the meat / fish fresh, or has it been marinated?”**
- **“Could you put the olive oil on the side, with no dressing?”**

CHOOSE / AVOID

What to pick, what to skip

General examples — tolerance differs from one person to another.

CHOOSE

- Grilled chicken
- Turkey
- Freshly cooked beef
- Simple steak
- Rice
- Boiled / baked potatoes
- Steamed vegetables
- Green salad
- Olive oil

AVOID

- Aged cheeses
- Cured meats
- Olives
- Pickles
- Tuna / sardines
- Smoked fish
- Sushi
- Long stews
- Fermented sauces, vinegar
- Wine / beer
- Tomatoes & spinach
- Chocolate

THE SIMPLE RULE

You don't have to avoid all of these forever. The goal is to understand how you react to them and when it's worth being more careful.

BY CUISINE

Don't choose the cuisine, choose the dish

In almost any restaurant there are simple options — and options that add a lot to the bucket.

Italian

Yes: simple pasta, grilled meat, grilled vegetables.

No: parmesan, salami, tomato sauce.

Asian

Yes: rice, steamed chicken, vegetables with no sauce.

No: soy sauce, miso, edamame, kimchi, sushi.

Grill / BBQ

Yes: fresh grilled meat, potatoes, vegetables.

No: sausages, marinades, sauces, smoked meat.

Home-style

Yes: roast, clear soup, simple sides.

No: long stews, pickles.

Mexican

Yes: grilled chicken, rice, plain tortilla.

No: salsa, pickled jalapeños, sauces, aged dishes.

Mediterranean

Yes: grilled meat, rice, simple salad.

No: long-kept hummus, olives, pickles, sauces.

DRINKS

Staying hydrated keeps the bucket low

SAFER

- Still water
- Linden tea
- Mint tea
- Rooibos
- Lemonade without citrus

AVOID

- Wine & beer
- Any alcohol
- Black / green tea
- Kombucha
- Citrus juices

ALCOHOL AND DAO

Alcohol is doubly tricky: it adds histamine (especially wine and beer) and blocks the DAO enzyme at the same time. So it both fills the bucket and slows its draining. If you do choose to drink, some people with HIT tolerate simple distilled spirits (e.g. plain vodka or gin) better than wine, beer or fermented drinks — but tolerance is very individual.

CHECKLIST

At the restaurant

-
- ☐ I chose the place in advance
 - ☐ I read the menu beforehand
 - ☐ I asked how it's cooked
 - ☐ I chose fresh & simple
 - ☐ I drank water, not alcohol
 - ☐ I enjoyed the evening

BONUS

4 mistakes at the restaurant

- **Going hungry**
On a big appetite you choose worse.
- **Being too shy to ask**
It's your health — questions are normal.
- **“Just one glass of wine”**
Alcohol blocks DAO — the risk is high.
- **Forgetting the side & sauce**
That's where tomatoes, vinegar and cheese hide.

COMING SOON

Soon, you won't be alone at the table

I'm building the MyHistamate app: photograph the restaurant menu and instantly see what you can order safely — not a generic list, but advice tailored to your history and your reactions.

- **Photograph the menu**
See instantly what's green or red.
- **Real-time advice**
Tailored to your case, not generic.
- **Learns from your journal**
Over time, it gets to know you better.

JOIN THE WAITING LIST

Be among the first to try it. Sign up free at myhistamate.com and I'll let you know the moment we launch.

Go out and enjoy.

A meal out shouldn't be a test. With a few simple choices, the restaurant becomes what it should be again: a joy.

[Discover MyHistamate](#)

This guide is for informational purposes only and does not replace professional medical advice. Histamine intolerance varies greatly from person to person — always consult your doctor before making significant changes to your diet or treatment.



MYHISTAMATE GUIDE

The histamine bucket.

The simple idea that explains why you have symptoms — and why “the same food” affects you differently.

FROM ME, TO YOU

When I understood the picture of the bucket, everything fell into place. It's the most useful image I can give you — let me explain it.

With love, Cătălina

Founder, MyHistamate

1

THE CONCEPT

Picture a bucket

Your body has a “bucket” for histamine. Imagine that every histamine-rich food, and every factor that triggers its release, adds a little into this bucket.

As long as your body manages to process and clear histamine quickly enough, the level in the bucket stays under control. But when the input is greater than the body's capacity to handle it, histamine starts to build up.

IMPORTANT

There isn't one same limit for everyone. Each person has their own “bucket size”, shaped by genetics, gut health, hormone levels and the body's overall state.

2

THE INPUTS

What fills the bucket

-
- **Food**
Foods high in histamine or that trigger its release.
 - **Stress**
The body releases histamine when you're on alert.
 - **Poor sleep**
Less rest = less clearing.
 - **Hormones**
Certain days of the cycle raise sensitivity.
 - **Environment**
Seasonal allergens, pollen, dust, mould.
 - **Slow transit**
Sluggish digestion lets histamine accumulate.

THE LIMIT

Every bucket has a limit

As long as your histamine level stays below your tolerance limit, your body manages it without trouble. The bucket doesn't need to be empty — it just needs to not fill beyond your body's capacity to cope.

That's why histamine intolerance isn't always about a single food. One day the bucket can be nearly empty, and your body handles a food with ease.

Another day — after a stressful stretch, a few nights of poor sleep, a sensitive phase of your cycle, or allergen exposure — the bucket may already be nearly full. In that context, the very same food that caused no problem yesterday can be the drop that makes it overflow. That's why reactions can sometimes seem unpredictable. It's not just about what you ate, but about everything that had already gathered in your bucket beforehand.

THE OVERFLOW

When it fills up, the symptoms appear

-
- **Migraines & dizziness**
 - **Itching & flushing**
 - **Palpitations**
 - **Bloating & cramps**
 - **Congestion & sneezing**
 - **Fatigue & brain fog**

3

INDIVIDUAL

Your bucket is yours alone

Some people have a bigger bucket and tolerate larger amounts of histamine without noticing any effect. Others have a smaller bucket and reach their tolerance limit sooner. The size of this bucket is influenced by many factors — from genetics and gut health to hormones, stress and the body's overall state.

That's why two people can eat the exact same meal and have completely different experiences. What one person tolerates well can be a problem for someone else. So it makes no sense to compare yourself with other people with HIT, or to look for a food list that works for everyone.

REMEMBER

General principles can help, but tolerance is deeply individual. In the end, what matters most is understanding your own body — noticing what fills your bucket and what helps it empty.

4

THE OUTPUTS

What helps the bucket empty

- **Hydration**

Water supports clearing, steadily through the day.

- **Good sleep**

The body regulates histamine most during sleep.

- **Calming stress**

Less alert = less histamine released.

- **Fresh meals**

Freshly cooked, eaten soon, no leftovers.

- **Time**

Between meals, the bucket needs a chance to drain.

- **Regular transit**

A gut that works clears histamine out of the body.

5

THE MECHANISM

The drainage system: the DAO enzyme

The body has its own ways of processing and clearing excess histamine. An important role is played by an enzyme called DAO (diamine oxidase), which helps break down histamine — especially the histamine that comes from food.

If histamine is what we collect in the bucket, DAO can be seen as the drainage system. The more efficiently this system works, the faster the body can process and clear the histamine that builds up.

DAO levels and activity differ from person to person, and when the clearing capacity is reduced, the bucket can fill faster than the body manages to empty it. The difference between how much goes in and how much comes out is the surplus that stays behind and fills your bucket.

REMEMBER

Alcohol and some medications block the DAO tap — so the bucket fills faster and drains more slowly.

THE STRATEGY

The key isn't to avoid everything

It's to manage your bucket so you have room for real life — for a dinner out, a birthday, a holiday, or simply the days when you can't control everything.

- **Leave room in the bucket**

On ordinary days, simpler choices give you more flexibility when you need it.

- **Think across a few days, not one meal**

Sometimes it's worth being more careful before an event or a demanding stretch.

- **Observe, don't judge**

A harder day doesn't mean you did something wrong. It's just information that helps you understand your own limits and patterns.

- **Seek balance, not perfection**

The goal isn't to live avoiding everything, but to find a way to manage your symptoms without them running your life.

MYTH VS. TRUTH

Let's clear up 3 confusions

-
- ☐ *"I'm allergic to these foods."*
 - ☐ It's not an allergy — it's a matter of accumulated amount, not an immune reaction to a single food.
 - ☐ *"I have to cut out everything forever."*
 - ☐ No. The goal is to know your limit and reintroduce gradually.
 - ☐ *"Once I've found the right list, the problem is solved."*
 - ☐ No. A few basic restrictions help most people with HIT, but no list can replace observing your own body and its reactions.

REMEMBER

3 things to take with you

- Symptoms appear when the bucket overflows
- Your bucket is unique — don't compare
- The goal is free space, not total deprivation

THE GOOD NEWS

The bucket isn't permanent. Your body's capacity to handle histamine can change over time. As you identify the factors that fill your bucket, support your gut health, manage stress and learn what works for you, you may tolerate things that used to cause problems. The goal isn't to remove everything with histamine and live in fear, but to understand what affects your tolerance and find a balance that lets you live as normally as possible.

COMING SOON

Soon, you'll see your bucket

More than a journal, MyHistamate is a companion built specifically for people with histamine intolerance. It looks at what you take in and helps you understand, over time, what fills your bucket, what empties it, and how food, stress, sleep and your cycle affect your symptoms.

- **Your bucket level, daily**
See how much room you have left each day.
- **Personalised correlations**
Discover which factors affect your symptoms.
- **Photograph the menu**
Quickly find the options that suit you best.
- **Patterns and trends**
Understand what repeats and what's worth watching.

JOIN THE WAITING LIST

Be among the first to try it. Sign up free and I'll let you know the moment we launch. In the meantime, you'll get free resources, articles and useful information about HIT.

Now you know how you work.

Keep the bucket in mind and no day will catch you by surprise again. Be patient with yourself — you're learning a new language, the language of your body.

[Discover MyHistamate](#)

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MYHISTAMATE GUIDE

Your first week after diagnosis.

Just found out you have histamine intolerance? Breathe. You don't have to understand everything at once.

FROM ME, TO YOU

I know exactly what the day you find out feels like. You don't have to solve it all today — this guide gives you one small step each day.

With love, Cătălina

Founder, MyHistamate

1

THE BASICS

What is histamine, really?

Histamine is a substance your body produces naturally. It has important roles: it helps digestion, supports the immune system and takes part in many normal processes. It isn't the enemy.

You also get histamine from food, and some foods contain more than others. The problem isn't histamine itself, but how much builds up versus how much your body can clear.

THE KEY IDEA

We all take in and consume histamine every day. The difference is that, in histamine intolerance, the body clears it less easily and symptoms can appear sooner.

2

THE BASICS

The enzyme that makes the difference: DAO

The body clears much of the histamine from food with the help of an enzyme called DAO (diamine oxidase). If DAO activity is low, histamine can build up faster than it's cleared, and symptoms can appear more easily.

Factors that can affect DAO activity:

- **Genetic predisposition**
- **Some medications**
- **Gut inflammation**
- **Alcohol consumption**

REMEMBER

Not all symptoms are caused by DAO alone. Histamine intolerance is influenced by several factors, and DAO is just one of the important pieces of the puzzle.

3

THE BASICS

Where histamine shows up

Because histamine circulates everywhere, symptoms can appear in places that seem unrelated. That's why it's so hard to diagnose.

- **Head & mind**
Migraines, dizziness, brain fog, sudden fatigue.
- **Skin**
Itching, redness, hives, sudden facial flushing.
- **Nose & breathing**
Congestion, sneezing, a runny nose with no cold.
- **Heart**
Palpitations, a racing pulse, a sudden “wave” feeling.
- **Digestive**
Bloating, cramps, nausea, disrupted transit.

YOUR WEEK

Your week at a glance

One step a day. Nothing more. Tick them off at your own pace.

DAY 1

Breathe. You don't have to learn it all today.

DAY 2

Tidy up the kitchen.

DAY 3

Build your safe list.

DAY 4

Start a symptom journal.

DAY 5

Hydrate and keep regular meal times.

DAY 6

Calm the stress.

DAY 7

Plan ahead for next week.

1

DAY 1

Breathe and understand

Histamine isn't an enemy. It's something your body produces and takes in daily — the problem only appears when too much builds up. In short: in histamine intolerance, the body doesn't always clear histamine fast enough. Over time it can accumulate, and symptoms can appear.

THINK OF THE “BUCKET”

Imagine a bucket. Food, stress, poor sleep and other factors fill it little by little. As long as the bucket doesn't overflow, you feel well. The goal isn't to avoid everything — it's to learn what fills your bucket and how to keep it under control.

Today, don't change anything. Just notice how you feel after meals. Tomorrow we begin, gently and without pressure.

2

DAY 2

Tidy up the kitchen

Set aside (not in the bin — just to one side for a few days) the foods that usually fill the bucket fast:

- **Aged cheeses & cured meats**
The more “matured”, the more histamine.
- **Canned or stored fish**
Canned tuna is among the highest.
- **Fermented foods & alcohol**
Pickles, kombucha, wine, beer.
- **Yesterday's leftovers**
Histamine rises as food sits.

A TIP FROM ME

Don't throw anything away. Set it aside for 7–10 days. You'll reintroduce it gradually later, to see exactly what bothers you — and what you can keep.

3

DAY 3

Build your safe list

Now the lovely part: what you can eat. Fill the fridge with fresh foods, cooked the same day:

- **Fresh meat & fish**
Ideally bought and cooked the same day.
- **Rice, potatoes, simple pasta**
Safe, filling sources of energy.
- **Fresh vegetables**
Cucumber, zucchini, carrot, lettuce, broccoli, potatoes.
- **Apples, pears, blueberries**
Gentle, low-histamine fruit.

A PRACTICAL TRICK

Cook larger portions and freeze whatever you don't eat right away. Freezing stops histamine from building up — so you always have a safe meal on hand.

4

DAY 4

Start the journal

Memory forgets details. A journal doesn't. Write a little every day — and your patterns will surface on their own.

NOTE FIVE THINGS

What you ate. How you felt. How much you slept. Which day of your cycle you're on. How your digestion was.

That's it. Five minutes a day is enough. Example: "Lunch — chicken with rice, feeling good. Slept 7h. Day 3 of cycle. Normal digestion." It can be that simple. After a few weeks, patterns start to appear on their own — links between food, sleep, stress, cycle and symptoms.

TIPS

Don't look for conclusions after two days — the journal is a tool for patterns, not instant answers. And note the good days too: sometimes you learn more from what works than from what doesn't.

5

DAY 5

Water, sleep, regular meals

Histamine isn't only about the plate. These basics make a huge difference:

- **Drink water steadily**
A glass before each meal.
- **Protect your sleep**
The body regulates histamine while you sleep.
- **Don't skip meals**
Regular meals keep the bucket steady.

TODAY'S CHALLENGE

Drink a glass of water as soon as you wake up. Eat at regular intervals. Try going to bed 30 minutes earlier. That's all for today.

6

DAY 6

Calm the stress

Stress fills the same bucket as food. When you're on alert, your body releases more histamine. That's why a hard day can bring symptoms even if you ate "clean".

TODAY'S CHALLENGE

5 minutes of slow breathing. A short walk outside. A break without your phone. Pick at least one.

What I learned: sometimes I had symptoms on a day I'd eaten "perfectly". For a long time I thought I'd done something wrong at the table. Often, the problem was that I was exhausted, stressed or hadn't slept well. You can't control everything that happens. But you can create small pauses that keep the bucket from filling too fast.

7 DAY 7

Make a plan for ahead

You've made it through the first week. Now don't rush — healing isn't a race.

- **Keep the journal going**
Patterns become clearer over time.
- **Keep things simple**
Don't add new rules every day.
- **Be patient with yourself**
Progress matters more than perfection.

REMEMBER

Some days will be good, others harder — and that's normal. Don't look for perfection, look for patterns. Don't look for overnight solutions, look for progress. Move forward at your own pace.

FOODS · GREEN

Often well tolerated

Fresh is the key word. Generally well tolerated by many people with HIT, but individual tolerance differs.

Meat & protein

- Eggs
- Chicken
- Turkey
- Fresh beef
- Fresh pork
- Duck
- Very fresh fish

Unfermented dairy

- Butter
- Pasteurised / UHT milk
- Sweet cream
- Ricotta
- Mascarpone
- Mozzarella

Fruit

- Apples
- Pears
- Apricots
- Melon
- Watermelon
- Pomegranate
- Grapes
- Blueberries
- Currants

Vegetables

- Carrot
- Zucchini
- Cucumber
- Broccoli
- Cauliflower
- Lettuce
- Radish
- Potato & sweet potato
- Parsnip
- Pumpkin
- Asparagus

Grains & starch

- Rice
- Quinoa
- Oats
- Plain corn
- Cornflakes

Fats & seeds

- Olive oil
- Coconut oil
- Rapeseed oil
- Pumpkin
- Flax
- Psyllium
- Sesame

Herbs & teas

- Basil
- Mint
- Oregano
- Parsley
- Rosemary
- Coriander
- Cinnamon
- Honey
- Rooibos
- Linden tea

FOODS · AMBER

To test, one at a time

For these, reactions vary a lot from person to person. Worth testing one at a time, in small amounts.

Fermented dairy

- Plain yogurt
- Sour cream

Nuts & seeds

- Almonds
- Hazelnuts

Fruit & veg

- Cherries
- Plums
- Mango
- Peaches
- Avocado
- Bananas

Spices & flavours

- Ginger
- Horseradish

HOW TO TEST

Introduce one new food, in a small amount. Wait 2–3 days and note in your journal how you feel. No reaction? It's probably ok for you. Amber doesn't mean "forbidden" — it just means it's worth testing carefully.

FOODS · RED

The ones that fill the bucket fast

Fermented & aged

- Aged cheeses
- Kefir
- Pickles
- Sauerkraut
- Soy sauce
- Miso
- Tempeh

Processed meat & fish

- Salami
- Ham
- Bacon
- Cured meats
- Tuna
- Sardines
- Mackerel
- Smoked foods

Vegetables & fruit

- Tomatoes
- Spinach
- Aubergine
- Olives
- Beans
- Chickpeas
- Lentils
- Citrus
- Strawberries
- Pineapple

Other

- Chocolate / cocoa
- Wine
- Beer
- Champagne
- Prosecco
- Vinegar
- Ketchup
- Mustard
- Green & black tea
- Yeast

Red doesn't mean these foods are excluded forever. They're simply the ones that most often cause symptoms, and that many people choose to avoid in the early period.

MEAL IDEAS

Simple safe combinations

A few simple combinations, so you're never out of ideas.

- **Breakfast**

Oats + blueberries + chia · Scrambled eggs + fresh flatbread + cucumber · Chia pudding with coconut milk + blueberries · Ricotta + peach + honey.

- **Lunch**

Grilled chicken breast + rice + zucchini · Baked turkey + roast potatoes + green salad · Clear chicken soup + carrot + celery · Quinoa + grilled chicken + cucumber.

- **Dinner**

Very fresh cod + boiled potatoes + broccoli · Turkey + grilled zucchini + rice · Pumpkin soup + carrot · Simple pasta + butter + broccoli.

BONUS

5 common mistakes

- **Cutting out absolutely everything**
The shorter the list gets, the harder life gets. Start simple, not perfect.
- **Comparing yourself to others**
What works for someone else may not work for you. Your body is the best guide.
- **Ignoring freshness**
Sometimes freshness matters more than the food itself.
- **Going through it alone**
You don't have to have all the answers by yourself.
- **Wanting overnight results**
Patterns appear over time. Give your body a few weeks, not a few days.

CHECKLIST

Your first week

-
- ☐ I understood the “bucket” concept
 - ☐ I tidied up the kitchen
 - ☐ I have a list of safe foods
 - ☐ I started a daily journal
 - ☐ I drink water & sleep better
 - ☐ I have a plan with my doctor

COMING SOON

Soon, you won't have to guess

I'm building the MyHistamate app because I wish it had existed when I started. You note your day, and the app finds your correlations between food, sleep, stress and symptoms. Not general rules, but patterns specific to your case.

- **An easy-to-use journal**
Note your day in a few seconds.
- **Personalised patterns & correlations**
See what shows up before the symptoms.
- **Photograph the menu**
Find out on the spot what you can order.

JOIN THE WAITING LIST

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You're on the right path.

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